SEO + GEO
MADE SIMPLE

A practical guide to website ranking, search visibility, and AI discovery.

RESEARCH → IMPLEMENTATION → MEASUREMENT

A plain-language reference for website owners, marketers, and project teams.

What this guide will help you do

First understand the main types of SEO, then check a website, decide what to fix, improve important pages, and measure the results. The guide covers traditional SEO plus GEO (visibility in generative AI answers) and AEO (clear answers to users' questions).

Key principle
Make the website easy to find, easy to understand, useful to people, trustworthy, and measurable. No checklist can guarantee a Google ranking or an AI citation.

1. Start Here: The Big Picture

SEO is a group of activities, not one single task. Use this overview to understand which areas matter and when to use them.

Area	In simple words	When to focus
Technical SEO	Make sure search engines can access and understand the site.	When pages are missing from search, errors exist, or the site is slow.
Keyword research	Find what the audience searches for and why.	Before choosing pages, writing content, or planning a campaign.
On-page SEO	Improve titles, headings, content, URLs, and links on each page.	For important service, product, and information pages.
Content SEO	Answer users' questions with useful, accurate information.	When pages are thin, outdated, unclear, or missing.
Off-page SEO	Earn genuine references and links from relevant websites.	When building reputation and authority over time.
Local SEO	Help nearby customers discover an eligible local business.	When a business serves a specific city or area.
Specialist SEO	Optimize products, images, videos, languages, or large sites.	Only when relevant to the website type.
GEO / AEO	Make content clear and credible for AI answers and direct-answer experiences.	Alongside SEO, especially for question-led and research queries.
Measurement	Check whether visibility creates useful visits and leads.	Throughout the project; review at least monthly.

Remember

Start with technical access, search intent, useful content, and measurement. Do not try to implement every specialist tactic on every website.

2. Main Types of SEO

These are the main workstreams you should know. Some overlap, and not every website needs every specialist area.

Type	Main tasks	Example
Technical SEO	Crawl/index checks, sitemap, robots.txt, redirects, canonical URLs, mobile and performance.	Fix a service page blocked by an accidental noindex tag.
On-page SEO	Titles, descriptions, headings, readable URLs, internal links, image alt text.	Make a service page clearly explain the service offered.
Keyword & intent research	Keyword ideas, audience questions, search results, competitor gaps, page mapping.	Match “SEO agency pricing” to a pricing guide or service page.
Content SEO	Helpful pages, guides, comparisons, case studies, content updates.	Write a useful guide based on real customer questions.
Off-page SEO / Digital PR	Earn relevant links, references, and credible brand mentions.	A reputable industry website references an original case study.
Local SEO	Accurate business profile, genuine reviews, location pages when useful.	A local service business improves its presence for nearby searches.
Image / Video SEO	Relevant media, file size, alt text, captions, transcripts, suitable metadata.	Compress a product image and add descriptive alt text.
E-commerce SEO	Product/category pages, variants, filters, stock/price accuracy, product feeds.	Ensure product details and availability are correct.
International SEO	Localized pages, language/region setup, hreflang and canonicals.	Serve separate English and Hindi pages correctly.
News / specialist SEO	Editorial quality and features specific to supported content types.	A publisher follows current news sitemap guidance.
UX & CRO	Mobile usability, forms, navigation, accessibility, calls to action.	Make the contact form easier to complete.
GEO / AEO	Clear facts, direct answers, credible evidence, AI visibility checks.	A well-supported guide may be cited by an AI answer.

Important

There is no public, complete list of every ranking signal. Treat official search-engine guidance as the source of truth, and treat third-party tool scores as estimates—not Google ranking scores.

3. The Correct Order of Work

Use this sequence for a new client project or an existing website. It prevents random changes and makes the work easier to report.

Step	What to do	Deliverable
1. Understand	Confirm business goals, audience, services, location, and desired action.	Brief and target pages
2. Audit	Check indexing, technical errors, content, mobile UX, analytics, and competitors.	Prioritized issue list
3. Research	Find search queries, intent, competitors, and content gaps.	Keyword and page map
4. Prioritize	Rank issues by impact, confidence, effort, and dependencies.	Approved task backlog
5. Fix technical issues	Resolve blockers and validate key pages.	Technical fixes with evidence
6. Optimize pages	Improve titles, headings, content, internal links, media, and CTAs.	Updated priority pages
7. Build authority	Publish useful original resources and earn relevant references.	Content and outreach plan
8. Add GEO/AEO practices	Clarify facts, answer questions, and track AI mentions/citations.	AI visibility log
9. Measure	Compare results with the starting baseline and plan the next sprint.	Monthly report

How to prioritize work

Fix problems that prevent important pages from being crawled or indexed first. Next focus on high-value pages, search intent, content quality, and conversion tracking. Leave low-impact cosmetic issues until later unless they affect usability.

4. Step One: Audit the Website

An audit is a structured inspection. Record evidence before changing anything.

Check	What to look for	Tool / evidence
Indexing	Are important pages indexed? Are they accidentally blocked?	Google Search Console URL Inspection
Crawl access	Robots rules, noindex tags, status codes, redirects.	Search Console and crawler
Sitemap & URLs	Is the sitemap current? Are canonical URLs consistent?	Sitemap and URL inspection
Page content	Does the page answer the query clearly and accurately?	Manual review and SERP comparison
Metadata	Missing/duplicate titles, descriptions, or unclear headings.	SEO crawler
Performance	Slow pages, oversized images, layout shifts, interaction issues.	PageSpeed Insights
Mobile UX	Navigation, buttons, text, forms, and layout on a phone.	Real device/browser testing
Internal links	Can users and crawlers reach priority pages?	Crawler and manual navigation
Conversions	Do forms, calls, and analytics events work?	Test submission and analytics
Authority	Relevant backlinks, genuine reviews, credible brand references.	Backlink tools and manual checks
AI visibility	Does the brand appear or get cited for relevant prompts?	Repeatable manual test log

Audit report template

Issue: What is wrong? **URL:** Where? **Evidence:** How do we know? **Impact:** Why does it matter? **Priority:** High/Medium/Low **Fix:** What needs to change? **Owner/status:** Who is responsible and is it complete?

5. Step Two: Keyword Research

The goal is to understand what people search for and what kind of page would best help them.

Simple process

- List the products, services, customer problems, and locations relevant to the business.
- Collect ideas from Search Console, Keyword Planner, Google Trends, autocomplete, customer questions, and competitor pages.
- Check the search results to understand intent: information, comparison, service/purchase, or navigation.
- Choose a suitable existing page for each topic. Create a new page only when it serves a distinct need.
- Prioritize by business relevance, evidence of demand, competition, and the ability to provide a better answer.

Example

Search query	Intent	Possible target page
website development company in Lucknow	Commercial/local	Service or location page
how much does a business website cost	Research/commercial	Pricing guide or service page section
how to improve website speed	Informational	Step-by-step guide
website speed optimization service	Commercial	Dedicated service page, if offered

Keyword sheet columns

Keyword • intent • location (if relevant) • volume estimate/source • current page/ranking • target URL • content gap • priority • owner • status.

Do not chase search volume alone. A smaller, highly relevant query may be more valuable than a broad query that attracts the wrong audience.

6. Step Three: Technical SEO

Priority	Action	How to verify
Critical	Fix accidental noindex, blocked important pages, server errors, wrong canonicals, redirect loops.	URL Inspection, status check, crawl test
High	Keep sitemap current; fix important broken links and redirect chains.	Sitemap review and crawler
High	Ensure key page content and links are available to crawlers, including JavaScript-rendered sites.	Rendered page and URL Inspection
Medium	Improve image sizes, caching, fonts, JavaScript and Core Web Vitals where evidence shows issues.	PageSpeed Insights and field data
Medium	Review mobile layout, HTTPS, duplicate URLs and relevant structured data.	Mobile tests, crawler, schema validation

Technical terms in plain English

Term	Simple meaning
Crawling	A search engine visits a page to discover its content and links.
Indexing	A search engine decides whether and how to store a page for search.
robots.txt	Rules that tell compliant crawlers which paths they may request; it is not a reliable way to hide private content.
noindex	A directive asking a search engine not to include a page in its index when the directive is processed.
Canonical	A signal indicating the preferred URL among duplicate or very similar pages.
XML sitemap	A file listing URLs you want search engines to discover; submission does not guarantee indexing.
Core Web Vitals	Measures related to loading, responsiveness, and visual stability.

If the site is built with React or Next.js, also test rendering, page-specific metadata, canonical URLs, and crawlable internal links.

7. Step Four: On-Page SEO and Content

For each important page, make it clear what the page offers, who it helps, and what the visitor should do next.

Element	What good looks like
SEO title	Unique, descriptive, relevant to the page; no repeated keyword lists.
Meta description	Accurate short summary; search engines may generate a different snippet.
Main heading	Clearly states the page's main topic.
Subheadings	Organize the content into logical sections.
Main content	Answers the search intent with accurate details, examples, and evidence.
Internal links	Connect relevant pages with descriptive link text.
Images	Useful images, reasonable file sizes, appropriate alt text.
Trust evidence	Real case studies, verifiable claims, company details, genuine testimonials where appropriate.
Call to action	Clear next step such as request a quote, contact, book, or learn more.

Content quality checklist

- Does it answer the main question early?
- Is it accurate, useful, original, and easy to read?
- Does it include practical examples or evidence where helpful?
- Does it match what the search results suggest the user wants?
- Are claims and statistics verifiable?
- Is the page better for the user than a generic summary?
- Is it linked from relevant pages and updated when facts change?

Avoid producing many near-identical pages just to target keyword variations. Create pages when there is a meaningful difference in user need.

8. Step Five: Authority, Local, and Specialist SEO

Authority and off-page SEO

- Earn relevant editorial links by publishing genuinely useful resources, research, or case studies.
- Build relationships with credible publications, partners, and industry communities.
- Keep official company information accurate across relevant platforms.
- Ask real customers for honest reviews and respond professionally.
- Avoid fake reviews, bulk low-quality directories, link schemes, and fabricated brand mentions.

Local SEO — only when relevant

- Claim and verify the eligible business profile.
- Keep business name, contact details, hours, category, and service information accurate.
- Create location pages only when they provide distinct, useful local information.
- Track calls, enquiries, direction requests, and local organic visits where possible.

Specialist SEO — choose based on the website

Website type	Additional checks
E-commerce	Product/category pages, variants, filters, stock/price accuracy, product feeds.
Image/video heavy	Image compression, alt text, captions/transcripts, thumbnails, relevant structured data.
Multi-language	Localized content, locale URLs, hreflang and canonical consistency.
Large website	Crawl efficiency, faceted navigation, URL parameters, pagination and duplicate control.
Publisher/news	Editorial standards, accuracy, freshness and supported news features.
SaaS/lead generation	Use-case pages, comparisons, case studies, lead forms and conversion tracking.

9. Step Six: GEO and AEO

GEO means Generative Engine Optimization: improving the chance that useful, credible information about a site or brand is discovered or referenced in AI-generated answers. **AEO** focuses on giving clear answers to users' questions.

Action	How to do it
Make key pages discoverable	Keep important pages crawlable, indexable where appropriate, and linked from relevant pages.
Explain the brand clearly	State what the company does, who it serves, what it offers, and where it operates when relevant.
Answer questions directly	Give a concise answer first, then add context, steps, examples, limitations, and evidence.
Add original value	Publish real case studies, research, first-hand experience, or useful comparisons.
Support factual claims	Use reliable sources and keep important facts current.
Build genuine authority	Earn relevant references; do not manufacture mentions or reviews.
Test AI visibility	Use a fixed set of relevant questions and record mentions, citations, and accuracy over time.

Example of answer-focused content

Question: What is technical SEO?

Technical SEO improves the way a website can be crawled, rendered, and indexed by search engines. Common tasks include checking robots rules, canonical URLs, redirects, sitemaps, rendering, and performance. The exact tasks depend on the website's condition.

Important reality check

There is no guaranteed method to appear in ChatGPT or Google AI answers. Google says its existing SEO fundamentals remain relevant to AI features and that special AI markup is not required. Clear content helps, but does not guarantee a citation.

10. Step Seven: Measure the Results

Goal	What to measure	Where
Google visibility	Impressions, clicks, CTR, average position, queries and pages.	Google Search Console
Technical health	Indexing issues, crawl errors, performance and mobile problems.	Search Console, PageSpeed Insights, crawler
Business outcomes	Organic leads, purchases, demo requests and conversion rate.	Analytics and CRM
Authority	Relevant referring domains, earned mentions, review quality.	Backlink tools and manual review
GEO / AEO	AI prompt mentions, cited URLs, answer accuracy, AI referral sessions and conversions.	Repeatable prompt log and analytics
Project delivery	Completed fixes, blockers, owner, due date and validation.	Issue register/project tracker

Monthly report should answer

- What did we change this month?
- Which results improved, declined, or stayed the same?
- What evidence supports the conclusion?
- Which issues remain and who owns them?
- What are the top three to five priorities for next month?

Do not report only rankings or tool scores. Tie search visibility to qualified traffic, leads, sales, or another agreed business goal.

11. A Simple 30-Day Starter Plan

Time	Main work	Output
Days 1–3	Confirm goals and access; record baseline; audit website.	Audit and baseline report
Days 4–6	Research keywords, intent, competitors and content gaps.	Keyword map
Days 7–10	Fix critical crawling, indexing, sitemap, canonical and redirect issues.	Validated technical fixes
Days 11–15	Optimize the most important pages and internal links.	On-page change log
Days 16–20	Improve or publish useful, evidence-supported content.	Content plan and updated pages
Days 21–23	Review relevant schema and local/specialist SEO needs.	Validation checklist
Days 24–26	Plan ethical digital PR and authority-building opportunities.	Outreach backlog
Days 27–28	Test a fixed set of AI prompts and record citations/mentions.	GEO/AEO observation log
Days 29–30	Compare with baseline and plan next month.	Monthly report

How to prioritize tasks

For each task, estimate **impact, confidence, and effort**. Work first on critical indexing or security issues, then high-impact pages and content. The 30-day plan is a starting schedule—not a promise of ranking gains within a month.

12. Reusable Checklist

Use this checklist for each website project. Mark a task complete only after checking the result.

Discovery

- Business goals, audience, target market, and conversion actions documented.
- Search competitors and user intent reviewed.
- Baseline and access confirmed.

Technical SEO

- Priority pages are accessible and not accidentally blocked/noindexed.
- Sitemap, canonicals, redirects, status codes, and internal links checked.
- Mobile UX and performance issues reviewed.
- Technical changes validated after release.

On-page and content

- Important pages mapped to search intent.
- Titles, headings, body content, images, and internal links reviewed.
- Content is accurate, useful, original, and evidence-supported.
- Duplicate or competing pages assessed.

Authority and GEO/AEO

- Relevant authority-building opportunities identified.
- Brand and service facts are clear and consistent.
- Question-based content answers users directly where appropriate.
- AI visibility tests recorded without promising rankings or citations.

Measurement

- Search Console and analytics events checked.
- Baseline and change log maintained.
- Monthly results and next actions documented.

13. Recommended Tools and Official References

Need	Tool / reference
Search performance and indexing	Google Search Console — https://search.google.com/search-console/about
Traffic and conversions	Google Analytics — https://analytics.google.com/
Speed diagnostics	PageSpeed Insights — https://pagespeed.web.dev/
Keyword ideas	Keyword Planner — https://ads.google.com/home/tools/keyword-planner/ ; Google Trends — https://trends.google.com/trends/
Site crawling	Screaming Frog — https://www.screamingfrog.co.uk/seo-spider/
SEO rules	Google Search Essentials — https://developers.google.com/search/docs/essentials
SEO starter guide	https://developers.google.com/search/docs/fundamentals/seo-starter-guide
Ranking systems overview	https://developers.google.com/search/docs/appearance/ranking-systems-guide
AI search guidance	https://developers.google.com/search/docs/appearance/ai-features
Structured data	Rich Results Test — https://search.google.com/test/rich-results ; Schema.org — https://schema.org/
Bing search	Bing Webmaster Tools — https://www.bing.com/webmasters/about

Final takeaway
Start with an audit, fix technical blockers, understand search intent, improve priority pages, publish genuinely useful content, build credible authority, and measure business results. Add GEO/AEO practices where they help users and make information clearer. Review and improve the plan every month.